CURRICULUM VITAE

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Education

B.Sc. Economics: London School of Economics (LSE), University of London
M.Sc. Economics: University College London (UCL) /School of Oriental and African Studies (SOAS), University of London
Ph.D. Economics: School of Oriental and African Studies (SOAS), University of London

Ph.D. thesis was an econometric and economic analysis of the determinants of economic growth, savings and investment in sub-Saharan Africa. Panel regression analysis was applied to data from a cross-section of over 30 countries in Africa over a 30-year period.

Employment

March 2007-to date
Director, Almandine Limited

I set up my own economic consultancy business to produce custom-made reports and advisory services to governments, NGOs and companies on the Middle East, Africa, and Asia.

The first project I led was for a major financial institution looking at credit growth and financial sector reform and regulation in the Arab Gulf states. At the beginning of 2008, I was approached by the Mo Ibrahim Foundation to work full time as Director of Research in London, a position that I decided to step down from in mid-2011 and to return to running my consultancy business. My current focus involves working very closely as director of research with 3 organisations: The World Wide Web Foundation, The Governance and Justice Group, and SBC4D.

May 2011 – to date: World Wide Web Foundation
Program Manager/Director of Research – Web Index

I am responsible for the design and production of the flagship quantitative products for the World Wide Web Foundation: the Web Index, the Open Data Barometer and the Affordability Report. The Web Index is a multi-dimensional measure of the Web's growth, utility and impact on people and nations. It tracks 86 developed and developing countries, incorporating indicators that assess the political, economic and social impact of the Web, as well as indicators of Web connectivity and infrastructure. The Index is produced to the highest technical statistical standards and was certified as robust and rigorous by one of the leading statistical departments in the European Commission working in this field. Both of the other products (the Open Data Barometer and the Affordability report) are incorporated in the Web Index.

Mid-2013-date:
Director of Research, The Justice Audit - Governance and Justice Group (GJG)

The GJG works on Justice Sector analysis and reform in various countries, using a data driven diagnostic approach. The Justice Audit examines a country's entire criminal justice system, illustrating how the justice process works, the points of system pressure and associated challenges, as well as opportunities to apply good practices to solve the sector's problems.

Working as a consultant director of research for the organisation, I am responsible for designing and directing the research data collection methods, and ensuring that those are rigorous and robust. This includes the design and implementation of statistically representative surveys in the countries where the work is being done (such as - most recently - in Bangladesh), and identifying, training, and working with local partners to implement the project.

The work is usually done in cooperation with the government of the host country, and is funded by either the government itself or an international donor agency (such as Germany's GIZ or the UK's DFID).

May 2008- April 2011
Director of Research, Mo Ibrahim Foundation, London
I led a team of analysts and advisors to produce the organisation's flagship product and core output: the Ibrahim Index of African Governance. The Index was devised to be a comprehensive tool through which the state of governance in African countries is assessed from the point of view of delivery of services to citizens. It is compiled using indicators of the level and quality of delivery of economic, social and political goods and services.

In addition to the technical and managerial responsibilities of my job, my work entailed building working relationships and cooperation partnerships with regional institutions and civil society organisations in Africa. I interacted with several multilateral and bilateral donor organisations, as well as high-level government officials. I was also responsible for the capacity development programme at the Foundation, identifying strategic partners and working closely with partner organizations in Africa as part of the Index project.

April 2001 – Feb 2007
Regional Director, Middle East and North Africa (MENA)
The Economist Intelligence Unit (EIU), The Economist Group, London

My work entailed managing and leading a team of analysts responsible for producing reports and analysis covering the 20 countries of the MENA region. A substantial proportion of my work involved ensuring the high quality of the analysis and reports

produced by the department, as well as writing and editing some of the reports on the region, which included reports assessing country risk using a detailed sovereign risk model (with both qualitative and quantitative inputs). We worked to very strict editorial and print deadlines, writing detailed monthly economic, sectoral and political reports for each country in the region, including providing forecasts for the main economic variables. The reports are read by a large number of subscription-based clients around the world, including institutions such as the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund, the European Investment Bank, governments and academic institutions, and many of the world's largest banks and corporations.

The job required excellent communication skills, both written and spoken. I interacted regularly with clients, spoke at conferences, gave media interviews and travelled to the region, where I often had working meetings with high-level government officials and key people from the private sector, civil society, and independent analysts and journalists.

I was also the Chief Financial Sector Analyst for a period of over two years. This involved leading and managing the EIU's financial sector analysis for many countries across the developed and emerging world, monitoring the quality of the reports and advising analysts on best practice for financial sector analysis

Jan 2000- Feb 2001
Economist, **Middle East Department**
International Monetary Fund (IMF), Washington, D.C., USA

My work involved conducting detailed economic and sectoral analysis and forecasting, contributing to staff reports, and presenting possible policy solutions and suggesting economic reforms to governments in areas such as monetary policy, financial sector reform, exchange rates and fiscal policies. I worked on several countries in the region, and my work entailed travel and meeting with high-level government officials and policy makers.

This required very strong analytical skills, the capacity to see though challenging economic circumstances clearly and insightfully, and the ability to communicate workable solutions clearly and concisely to high-level government officials, policy makers and other interested parties.

July 1997-Feb 2000
Head of Research (economics, equity and fixed income)
FBC Investment Bank, Johannesburg, South Africa

FBC Investment Bank was a newly formed financial institution, established in the spirit of "black economic empowerment" in South Africa. It was part of a larger corporation (Thebe Investment Corporation) that was established in the context of the new (post-apartheid) wave of African companies set up to address some of the inequities of the previous South African regime.

I was hired to establish a research department for the Investment Bank, to help support the bank's business in this area and boost client relationships.

The high quality daily, monthly and quarterly reports my department produced, as well as the media profile I contributed to, were very well received. The department I set up published reports on the local and global equity, fixed income, and currency markets, as well as in-depth research on the local and international economies. Feedback from the bank's clients (which included several of the country's leading fund management institutions), along with invitations to speak at conferences on the South African and global economies, indicated that we had built a respected unit. The job also entailed regular meetings with key policy makers and high-level government officials.

Jan 1994-July 1997
Chief Economist
ING Barings Investment Bank, London and Johannesburg

I was part of a team of economists responsible for producing economic, political and sectoral research for the Middle East, Africa, Eastern Europe and Southern Europe, on the stockbroking and fixed-income side of the business.

In late 1995/early1996 I transferred to South Africa (to the Johannesburg office) to take up the position of Chief Economist. My work entailed analysing and forecasting all the main economic indicators, such as economic growth, inflation, interest rates, exchange rates, and sectoral trends, as well as participating in strategy decisions on asset allocation, and assessing currency risk and overall country risk.

The Bank's clients were mainly portfolio fund managers in Europe, the US, and South Africa. The job required insightful analysis, strong communication skills and a high media profile, as well as travel for research and analysis. I often met with and gave presentations to clients, policy makers and senior government officials.

Languages

Arabic (fluent), French (upper intermediate conversational and reading).